

6.3 Contest Sites

These are sites which either keeps track of contests being held on other sites or hold contests themselves. The emphasis in this section is on contests that are open to all individuals, have no entry fees, and are conducted online—meaning there is no need to send the prints of the art work physically.

The search phrases used by this reviewer to find these sites with Google search are: graphics, design, contest, competition, “xyz” (replace xyz with preferred application name).

It needs to be noted that forums in sites are places to look for contests. In such forums, users themselves create contests to challenge other users, without the intervention of the site authorities. The details of such contests are available in the forum. It is common to find members of the forum challenging others to improve upon some work that they have already done. Some of the sites already mentioned in this chapter and the preceding and succeeding chapters have forums which hold contests, and hence deserve a mention.

6.3.1 <http://www.photoshoptalent.com/>

This site holds regular contests for its registered users. The winning three entries get real prizes that can be either items from sponsors or points, which can be converted into cash (at present, payment is effected through PayPal only). As a registered user, you can take part, and upload your work. Other users vote on your work and the one with maximum votes wins. Users who win contests are given a higher ranking in the site, and their votes carry more weight than that of the normal user. The voting system, therefore, is a bit complicated. But the FAQ offers a thorough explanation of how the final votes are tallied.

The site conducts different types of contests: some contests are reserved for those with higher levels (the more the number of contests you win, the higher your level); some contests are for people